Young Women's Labour-Market Inclusion

Preliminary findings, Ukraine

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1 · Data and variables

Data sources

- **SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021** (anonymised public-use file): 265.6k interviews from 151.7k persons aged 15+ in 88.1k households; rotation panel; collected before February 2022. Age is released in bands (15–24, 25–29 and older); the file has no earnings, household composition, displacement or disability variables.
- **UNICEF Household Social and Economic Status Survey (HSESS)**, December 2023 to February 2024, Institute of Demography and Quality of Life Problems: 18,838 individuals in 8,024 households, all regions except the occupied territories and Luhansk oblast. Single-year age; employment questions from age 15; displacement, disability (household level), childcare, earnings and household income.
- **MICS-7 2025/26**: access pending.

Age groups

Age group	Indicators	Notes
15–18	Education, training, NEET	Ages 14–17 are legal minors; HSESS asks employment questions from age 15
19–24	Labour-force participation, employment, job quality, earnings, NEET	
15–24	Education-to-work transition, NEET	UNICEF programme age range
15–29	NEET	ILO age range for NEET, shown for reference

The LFS 2021 public file releases age in bands, so LFS results are shown for 15–24 (and 15–29 for NEET). The 15–18 and 19–24 groups use HSESS 2023/24, and MICS-7 once available.

Variables and definitions

Concept	Definition	LFS 2021
Labour-force participation	Employed or unemployed (ILO)	`labour_force` 1–2
Employed	Worked at least one hour for pay or profit in the reference week, or temporarily absent	`labour_force` = 1
Unemployment rate	Unemployed (no work, searched in last 4 weeks, available) as share of the labour force	`labour_force` = 2
NEET	Not employed and not in education. In the LFS public file, unemployed students cannot be identified, so the LFS rate is an upper bound	`labour_force`, `reason_inactiv`
Care burden (proxy)	Outside the labour force because of home or family duties	`reason_inactiv` = 3
Informal employment	No social contributions, no paid leave or sick leave, or oral agreement	`informal_empl` = 1
Short hours	Under 30 hours actually worked in the reference week	`actual_duration` 1–2
Occupational segregation	Dissimilarity index: share of women (or men) who would have to change occupation for equal distributions	`occupation` (9 groups)

HSESS uses the same definitions: employment from IND_B1 (production for own household use only is not counted as employment), education from IND_A9, and labour-force participation as employed or looking for work or starting a business (IND_B21).

Key variables (1/2)

Concept	Use	LFS 2021	HSESS 2023/24
Age	Groups 15-18, 19-24; 15-29 for NEET	age_gr (bands: 15-24, 25-29)	IND_A2 age in years
Sex	Breakdown by sex	sex	IND_A3 sex
Survey weight / design	Weighted estimates	weight_year; kod_res	Final weight; household key
Region	Regional breakdown	rg	OBLAST
Urban / rural	Urban/rural breakdown	tp_ar	SETTL_TYPE
Displacement	Breakdown by displacement status	not available	IND_A19 IDP status
Disability	Breakdown by disability in household	not available	D1_Mult3/4 household member with disability
Marital status	Household formation	marital_st	IND_A6 marital status
Motherhood	Breakdown by motherhood	not available	Lives with own child under 18 (IND_A1 relationship, roster ages)
Young children	Childcare responsibilities	not available	Child under 6 in household (roster ages)
Daily childcare	Childcare responsibilities	reason_inactiv = 3 (proxy)	IND_B28_1 cares for own children daily

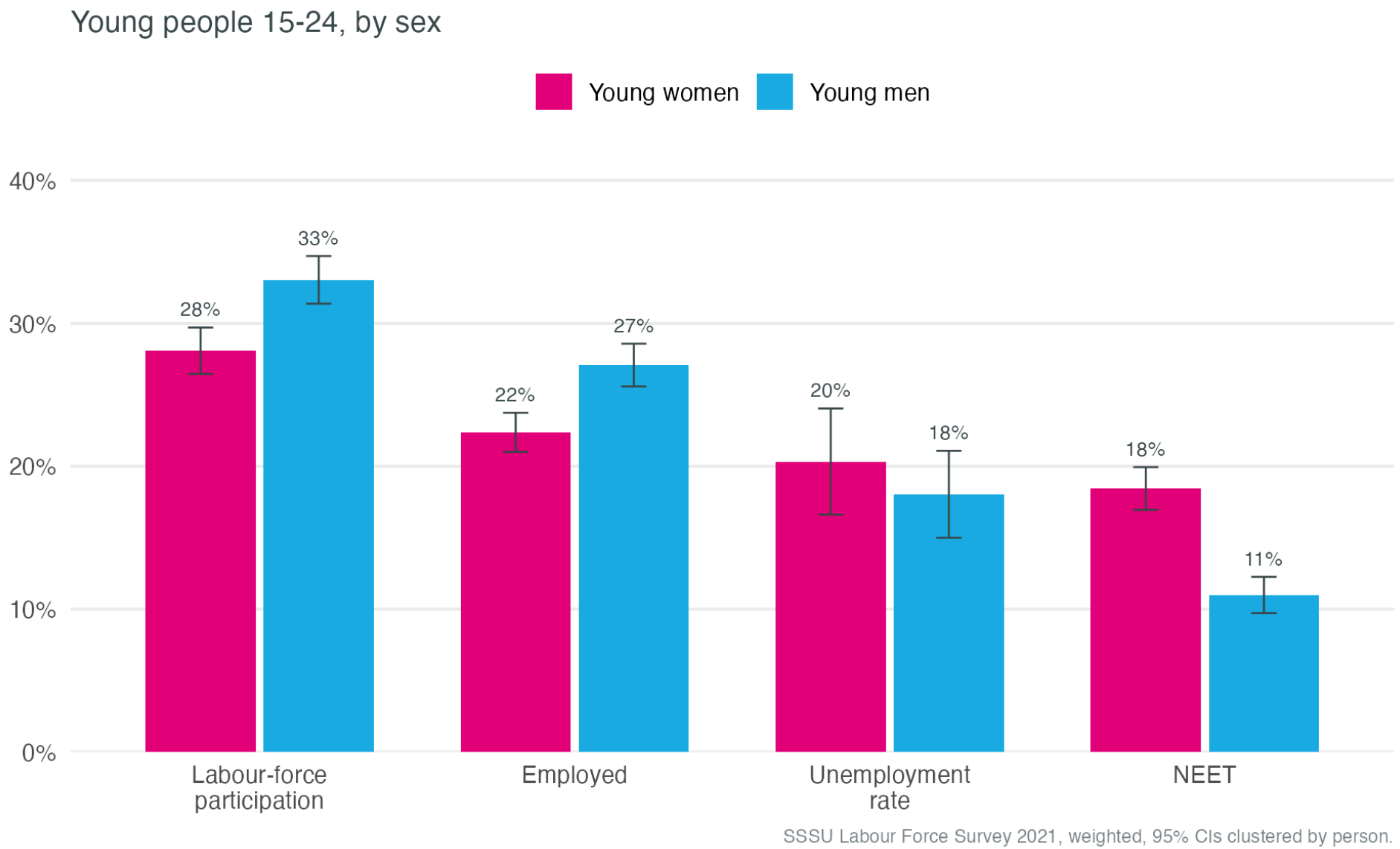
Key variables (2/2)

Concept	Use	LFS 2021	HSESS 2023/24
Childcare access	Preschool attendance	not available	IND_A14 why a child does not attend preschool
Household income	Income breakdown, costing	not available	V1 household income per member
Education level	Education-to-work transition	education; special_dipl	IND_A7 education level
In education	Enrolment, NEET	reason_inactiv = 2	IND_A9 currently in education; IND_A10 type of institution
Employment	Participation, employment, NEET	labour_force	IND_B1 status in reference week
Job search	Unemployment	labour_force = 2; durat_job_search	IND_B21 looking for work
Reason not working	Reasons for inactivity	reason_inactiv; reason_unempl	IND_B24 reason not working or seeking
Occupation / sector	Occupational distribution, earnings	occupation	IND_B6_2 occupation; IND_B5_2 sector
Job quality	Informality, hours	informal_empl; actual_duration	IND_B3_1 contract; IND_B9_1 hours; IND_B10_1
Earnings	Wage differences, costing	not available	IND_V1_1_1 monthly amount (wages)

HSESS codes follow the questionnaire (A = demographics and education, B = employment, V = income; D1 = household characteristics). Full list of variables: output/inventory/variable_report.xlsx.

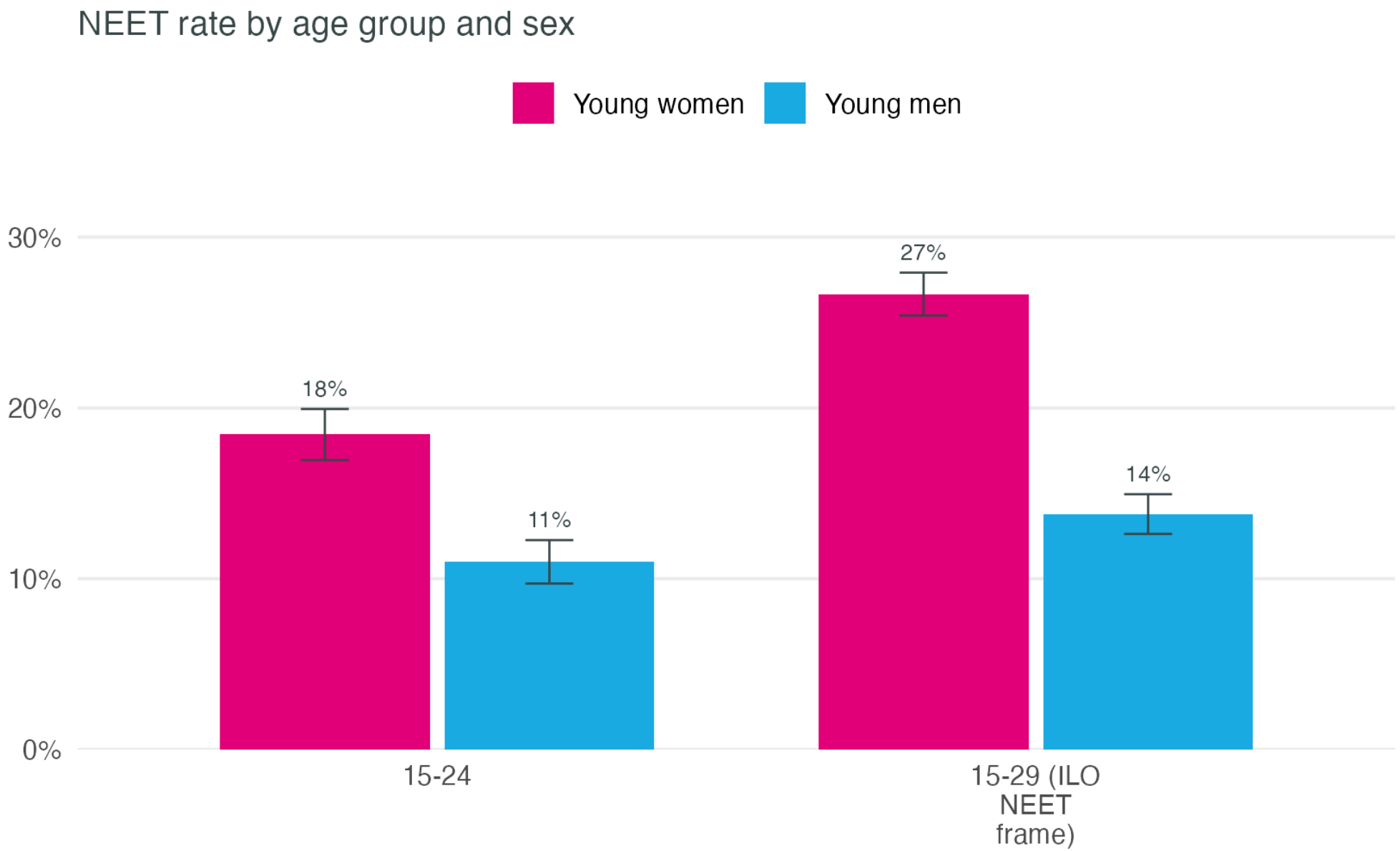
2 · Labour Force Survey 2021

NEET rate at 15–24: 18% for women and 11% for men



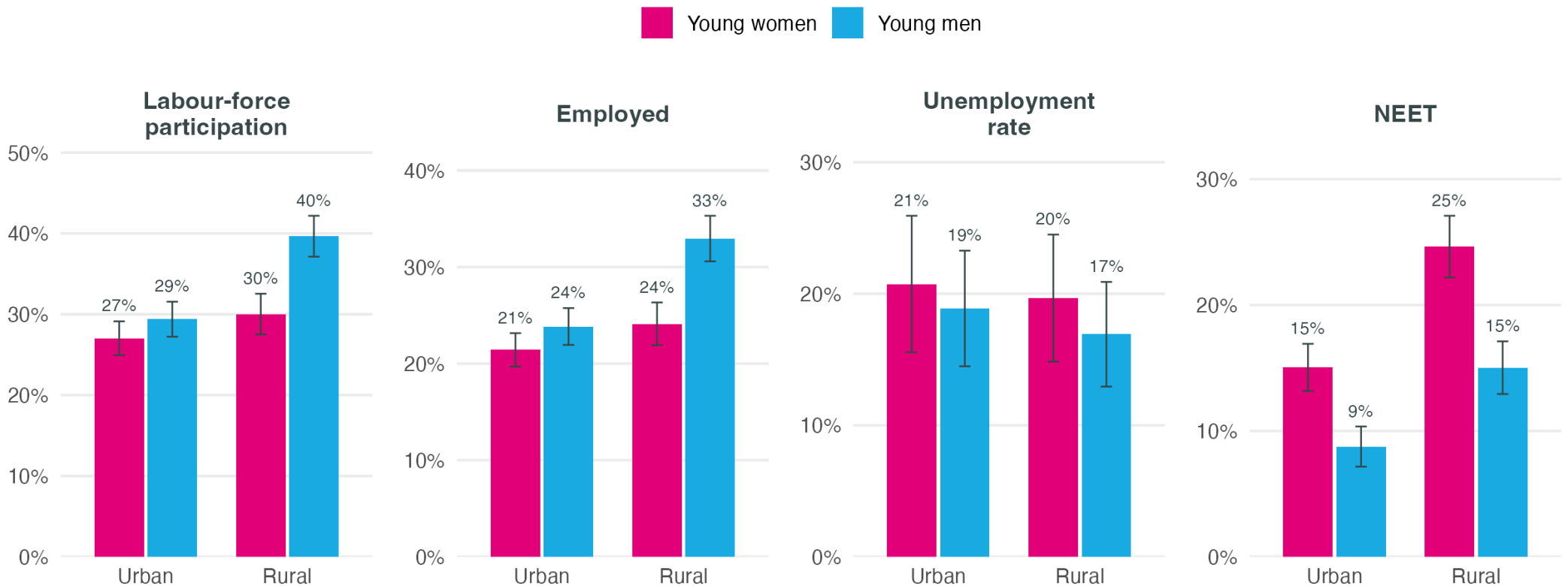
Ages 15–24, 2021. Labour-force participation: women 28%, men 33%. Employed: women 22%, men 27%. Unemployment rate: women 20%, men 18%. The public file releases age in bands, so 19–24 cannot be shown separately; HSESS results for 19–24 are in section 3.

NEET rate at 15–29 (ILO age range): 27% for women and 14% for men



Outcomes by urban and rural area, 15–24

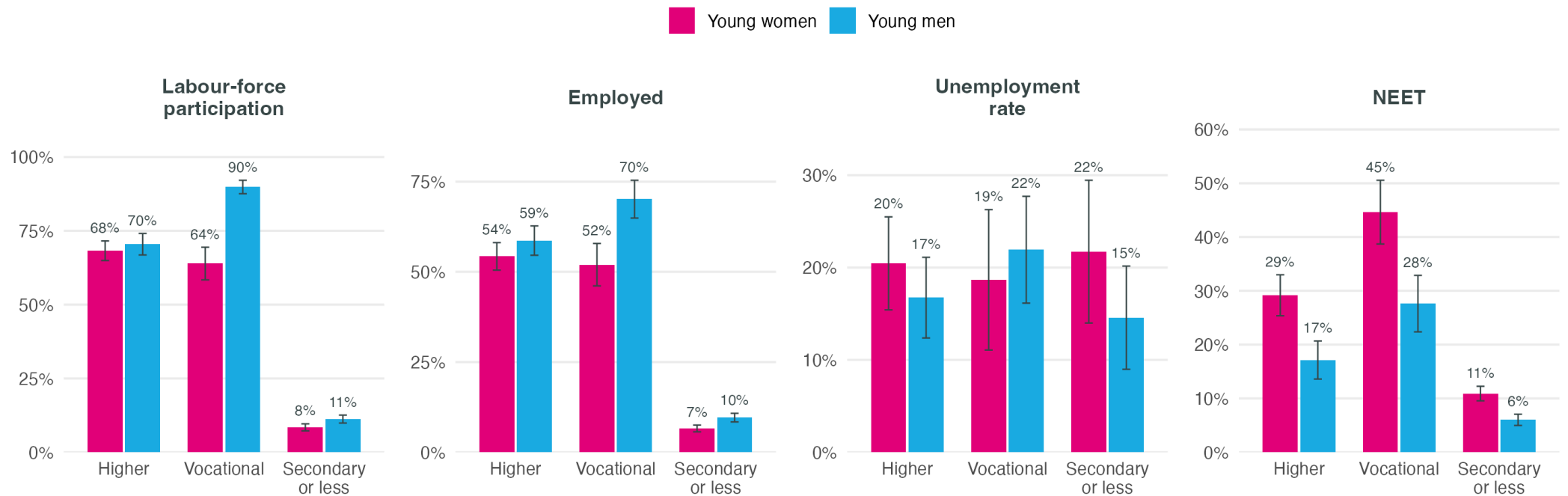
By urban/rural area and sex, 15-24



SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by person.

Outcomes by education level, 15–24

By education level and sex, 15-24

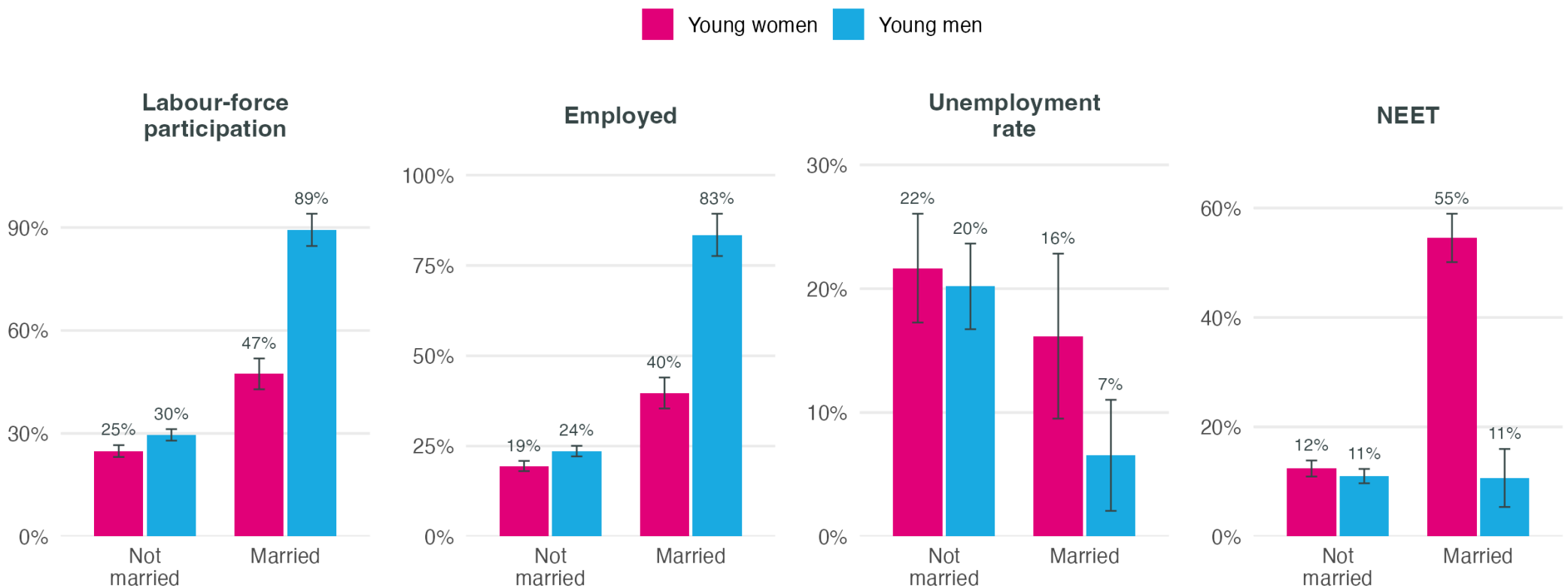


SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by person.

Highest level completed. “Vocational” is vocational-technical education; “Secondary or less” includes those still studying.

Outcomes by marital status, 15–24

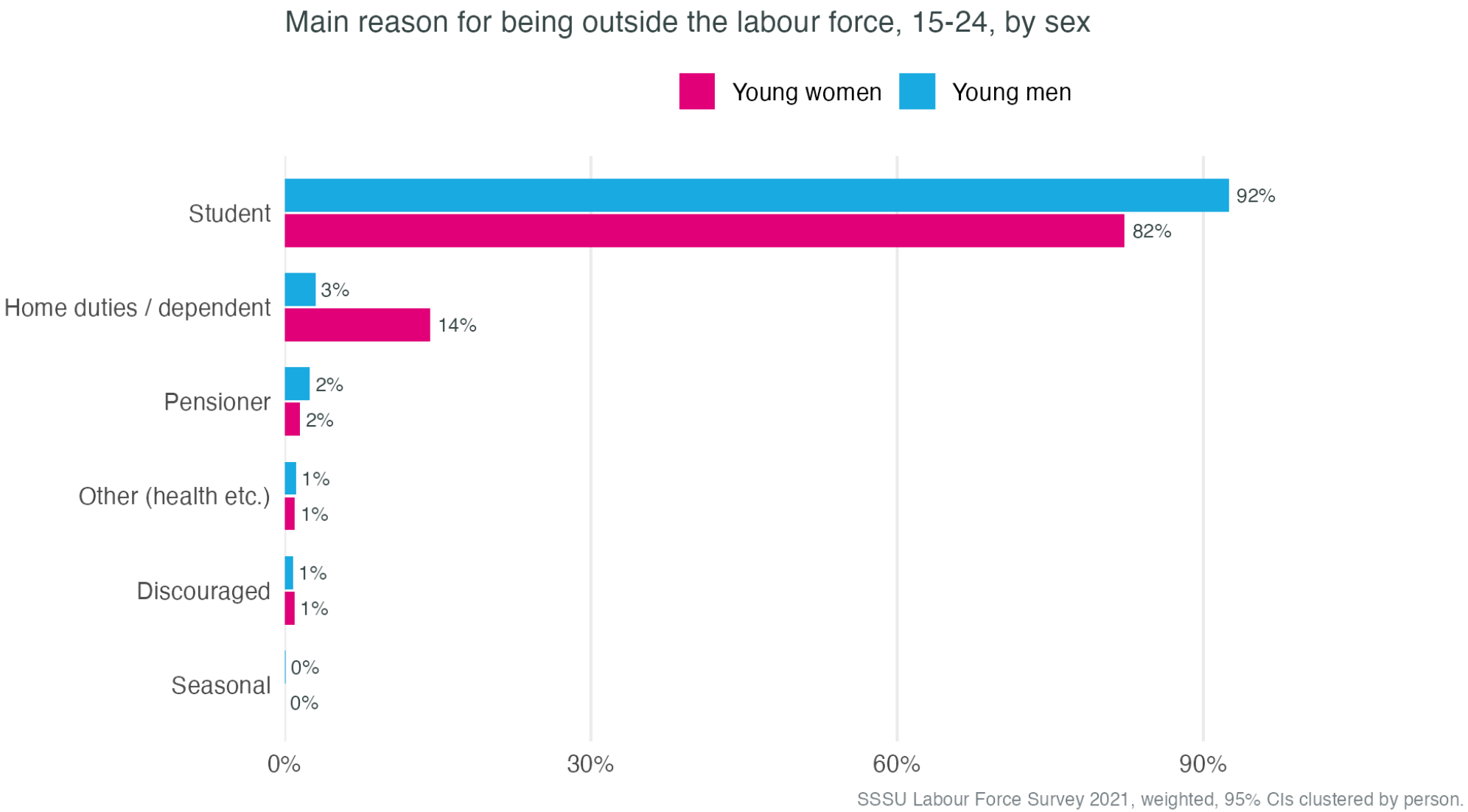
By marital status and sex, 15-24



SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by person.

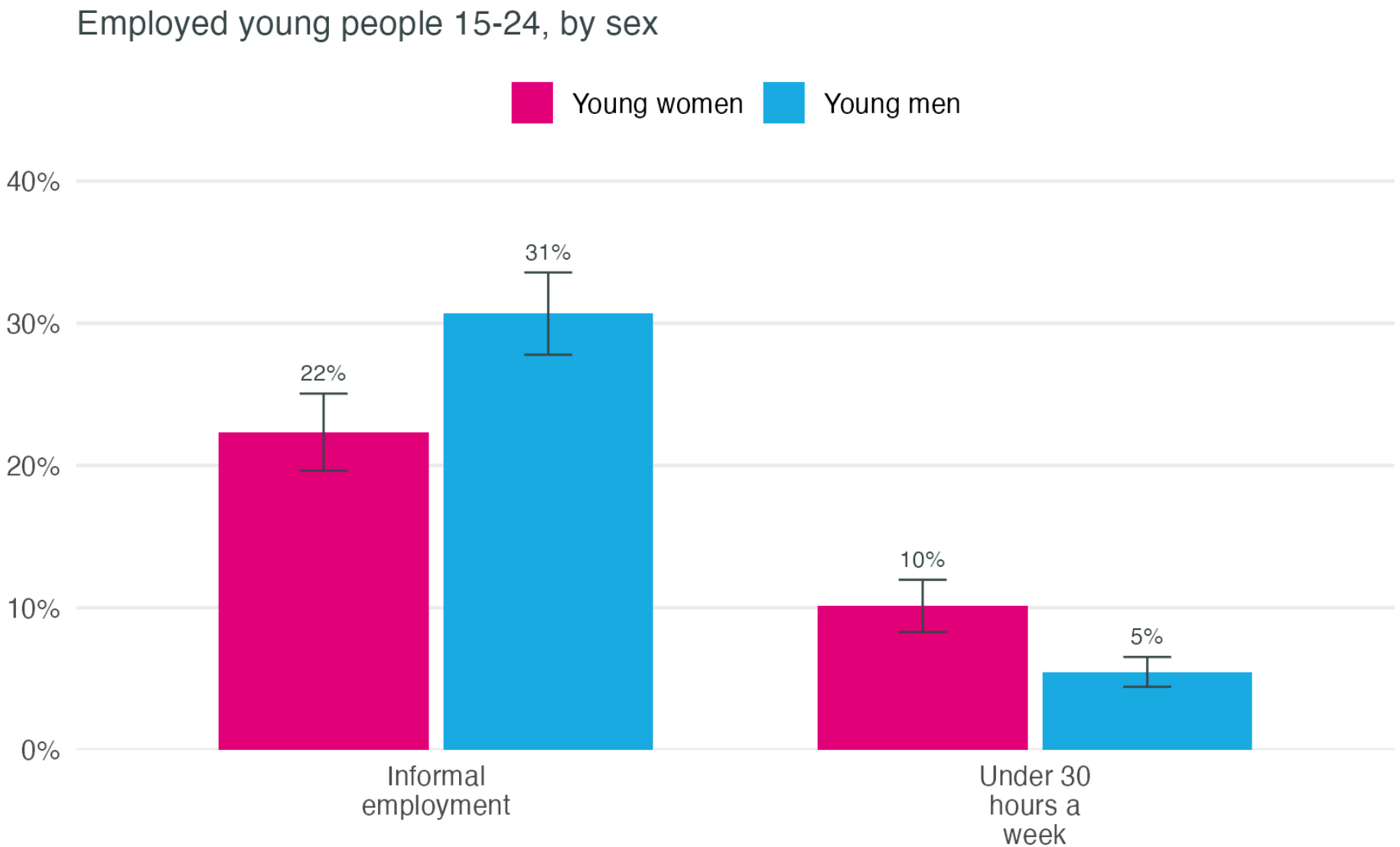
The public file has no information on children; marital status is the closest available indicator of household formation. Results by motherhood use HSESS 2023/24 (section 3).

Home duties as main reason for inactivity: 14% of inactive women and 3% of inactive men, 15–24



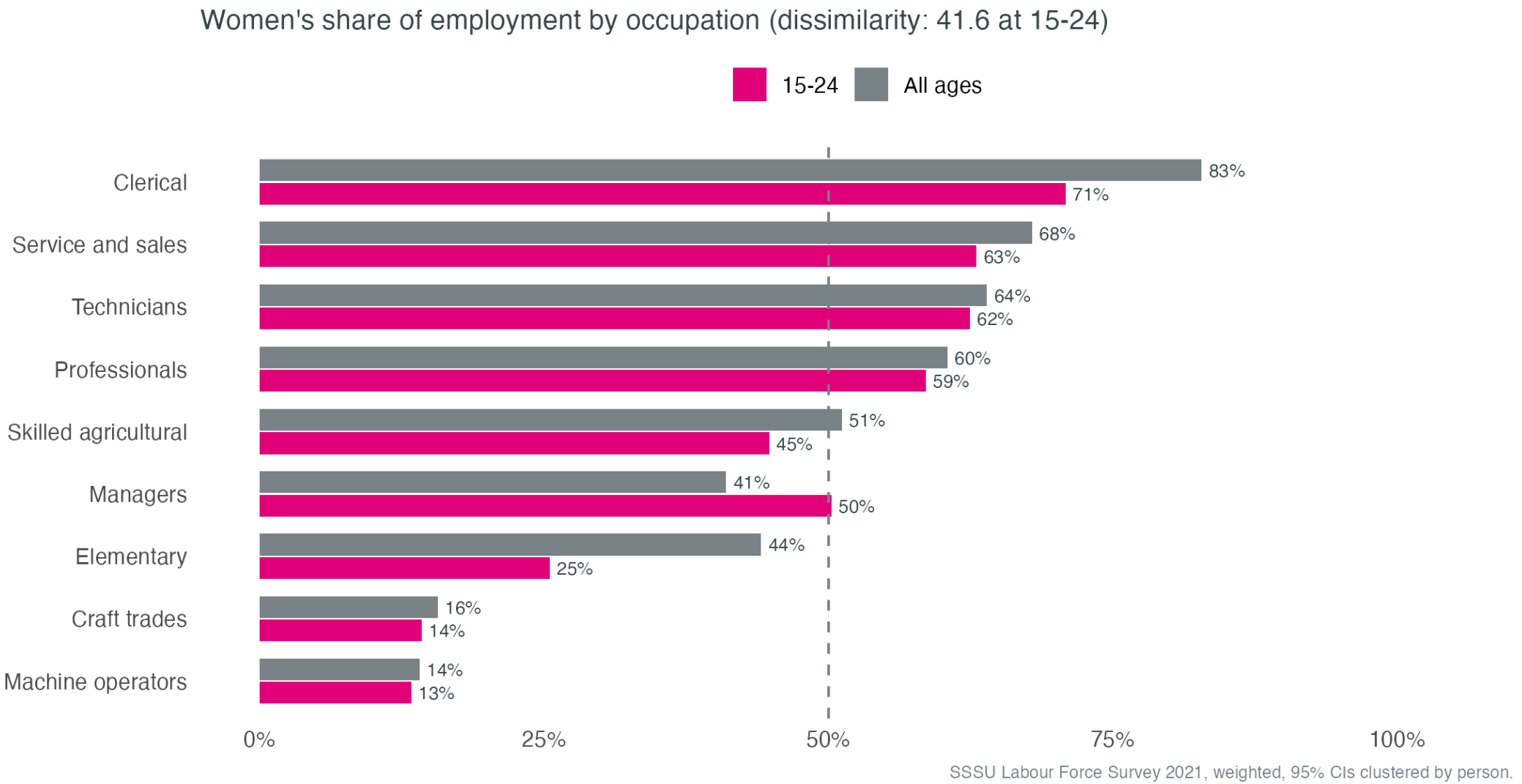
Main reason for being outside the labour force, among those outside it. The category “Home duties / dependent” includes care for family members.

Informal employment: 22% of employed women and 31% of employed men, 15–24



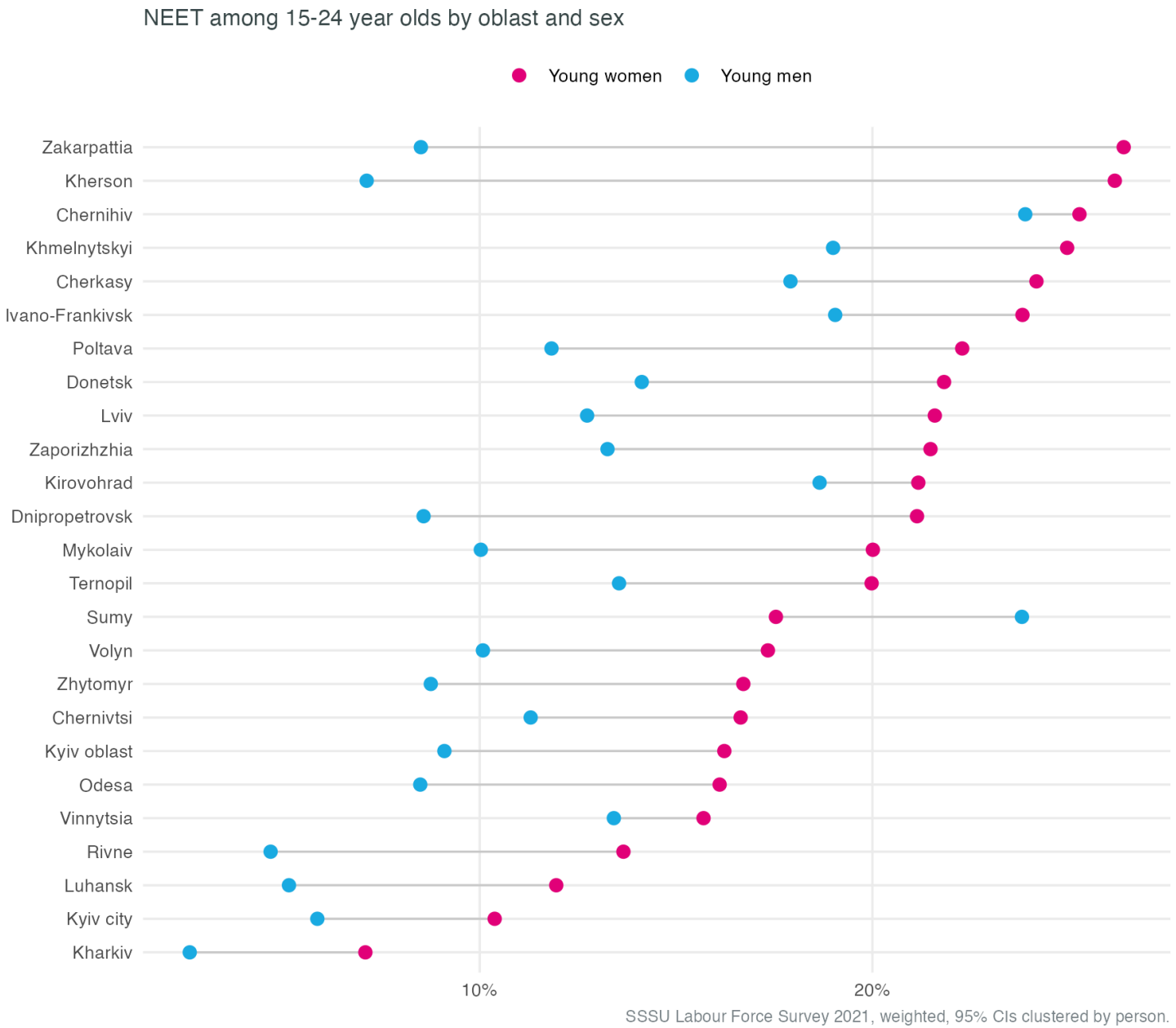
SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by person.

Occupational dissimilarity index: 41.6 at 15–24 and 35.2 for all ages

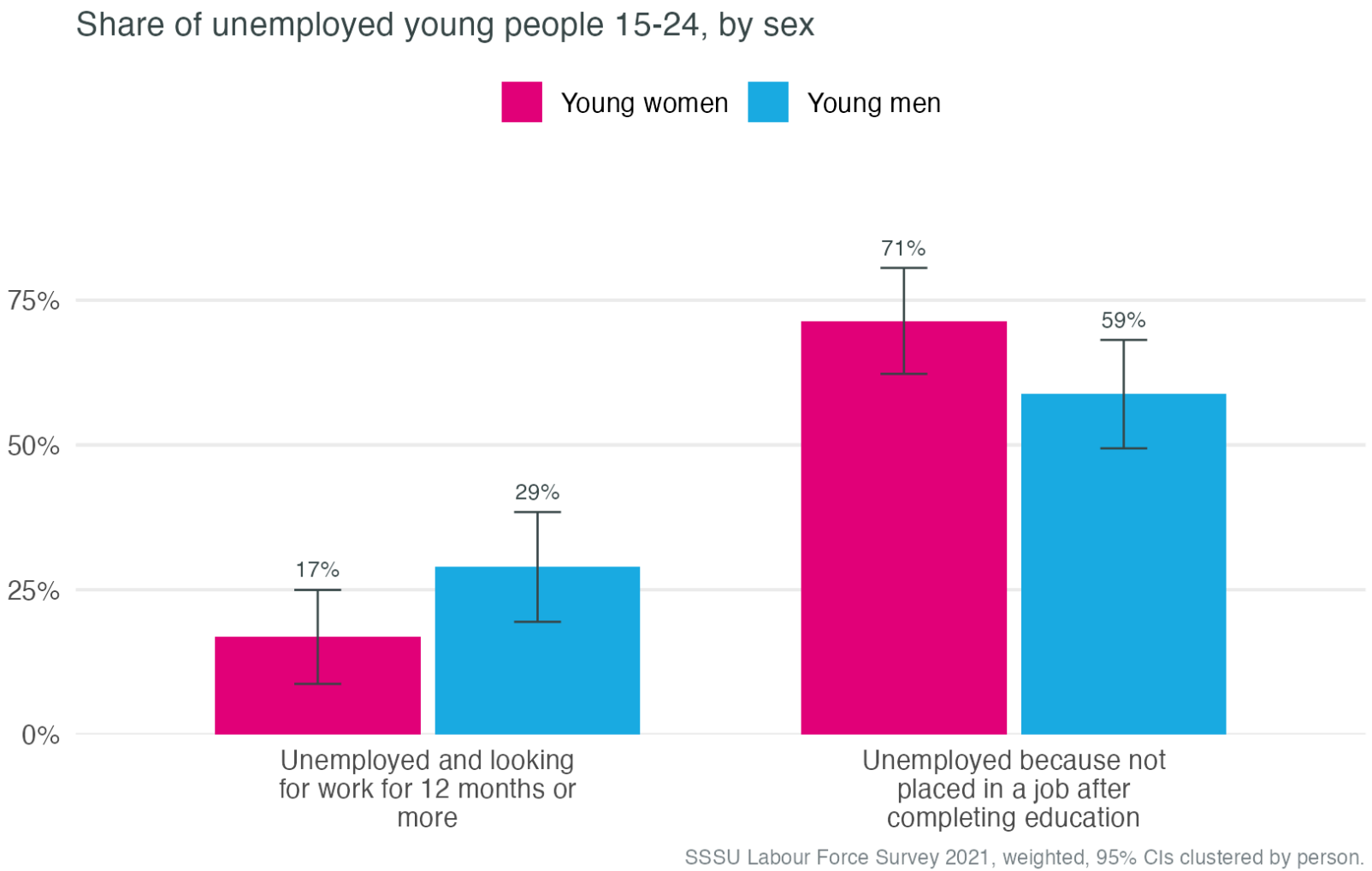


Share of employed women (or men) who would have to change occupation group for women and men to have the same distribution. Occupations at the first digit of the national classification (9 groups).

NEET rate at 15–24 by oblast

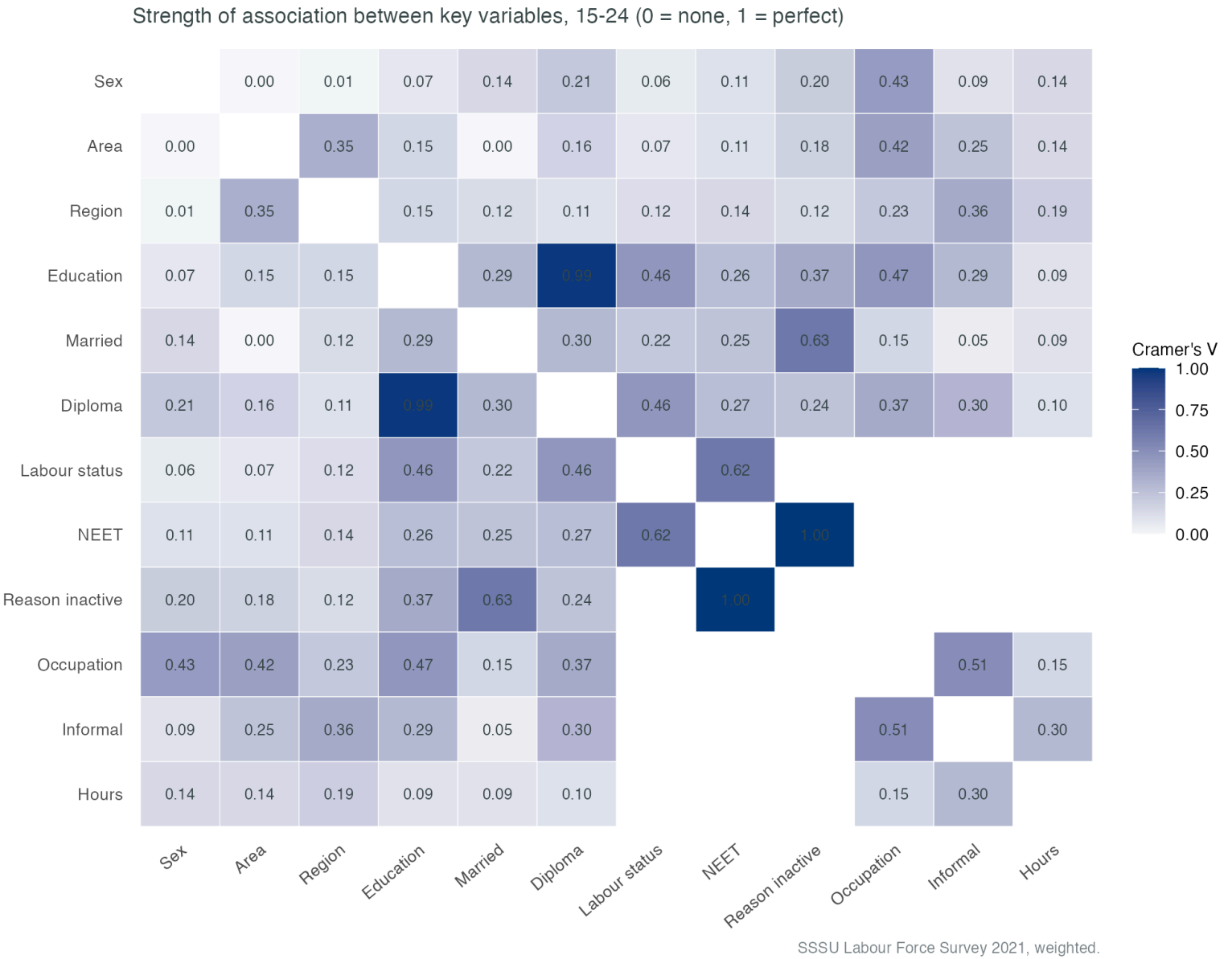


Long-term unemployment and unemployment after completing education, 15–24



Among those unemployed at the time of the interview: share who have been looking for work for 12 months or more (long-term unemployment), and share whose main reason for unemployment is not having been placed in a job after completing education. Both groups were still unemployed when interviewed; the survey does not record later outcomes.

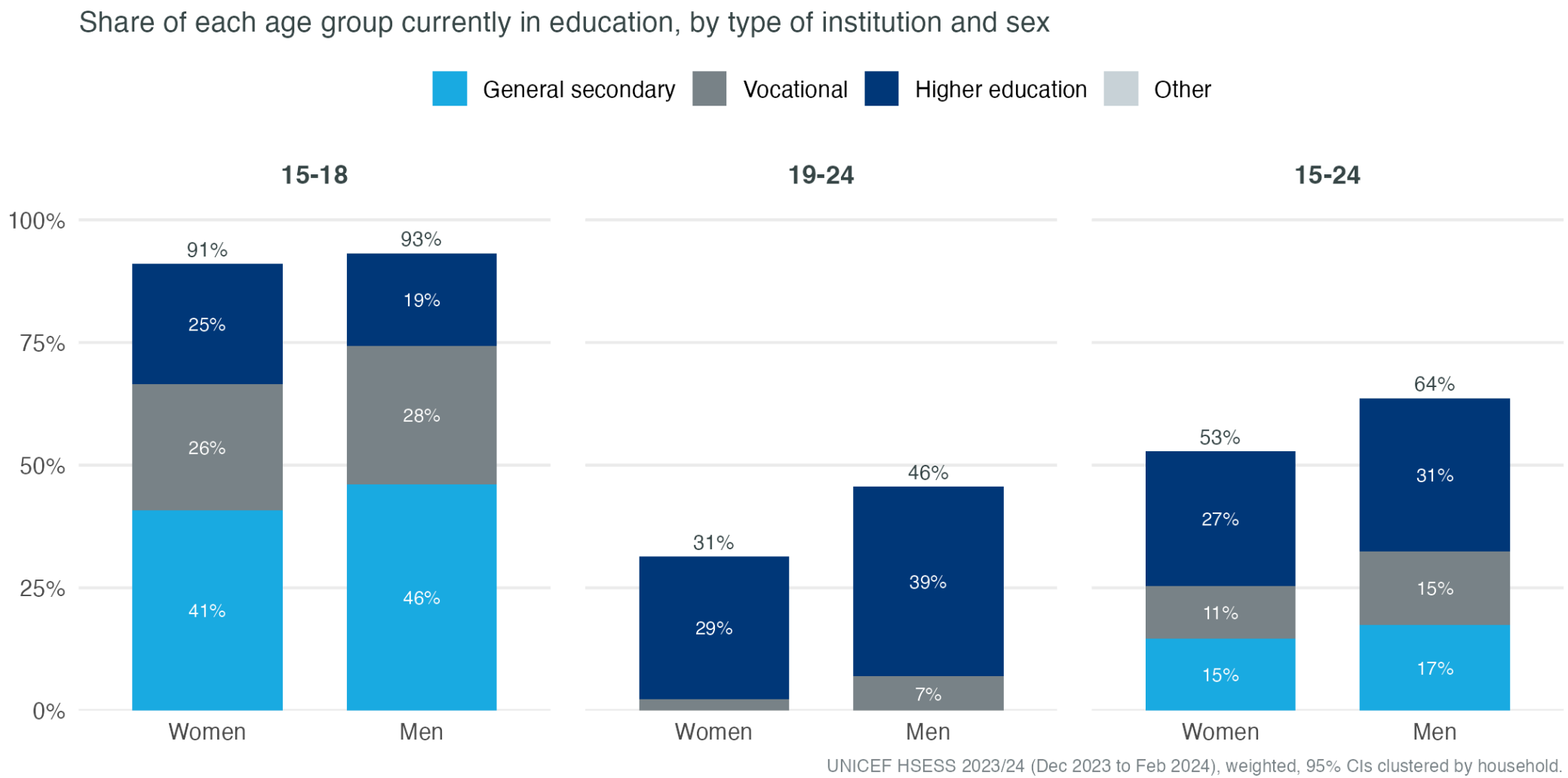
Association between key variables, 15–24



Cramer's V between each pair of variables, weighted (0 = no association, 1 = perfect association).

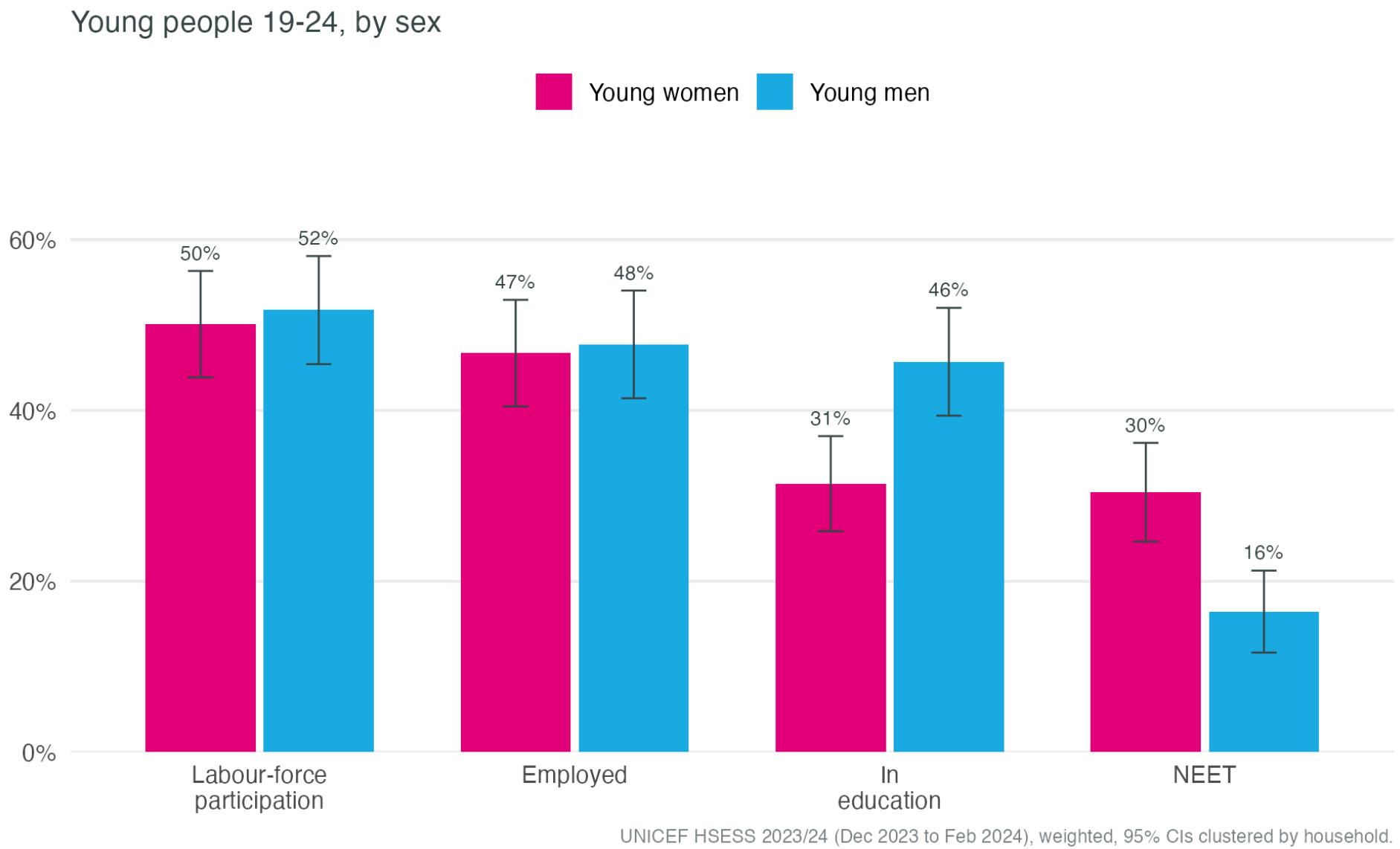
3 · Household Social and Economic Status Survey 2023/24

In education at 15–24: 53% of women and 64% of men



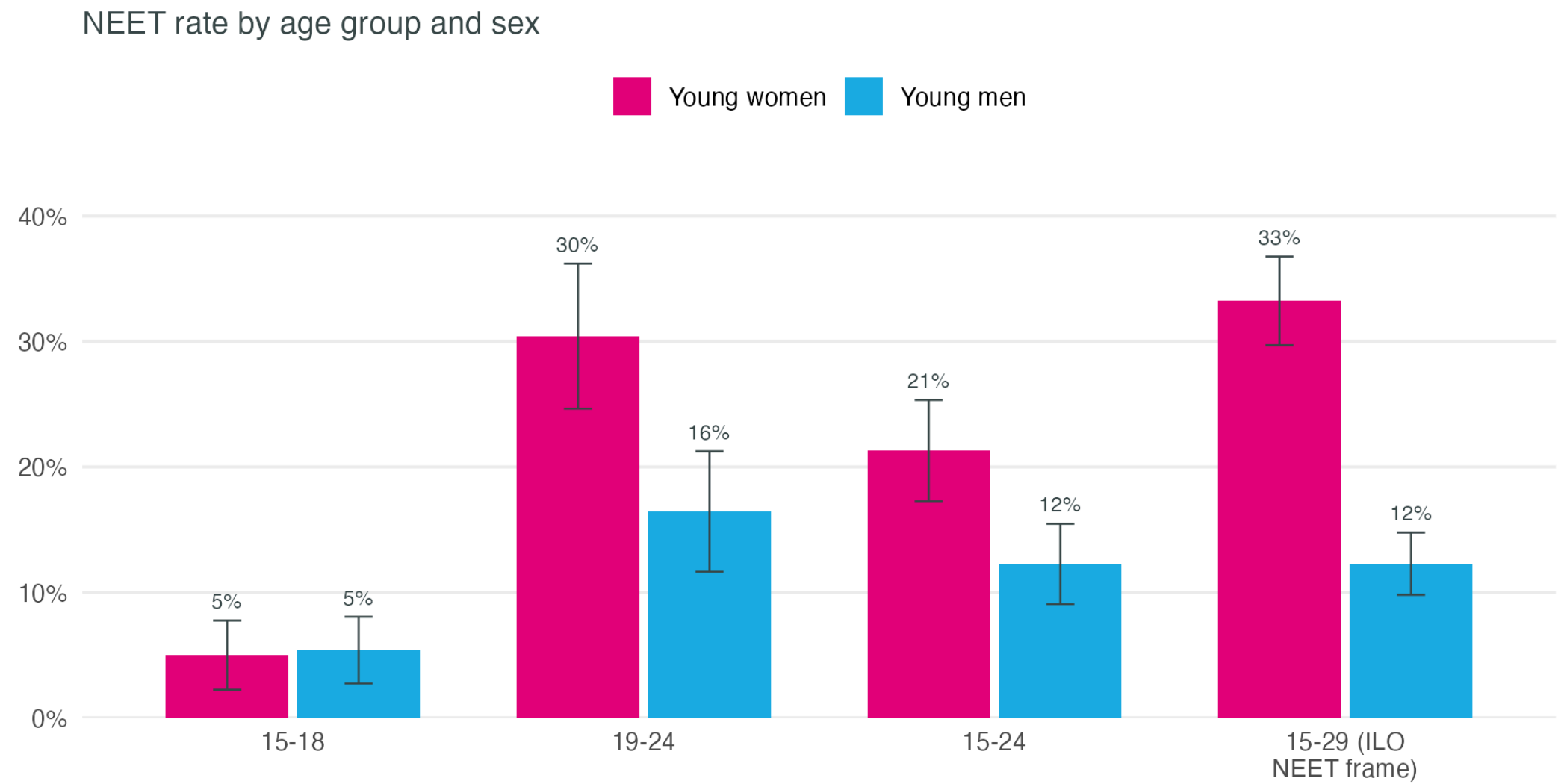
Share of each age group currently in education, by type of institution. In higher education at 19–24: women 29%, men 39%. General secondary includes general schools; vocational includes professional-technical institutions.

Labour-force participation at 19–24: 50% for women and 52% for men



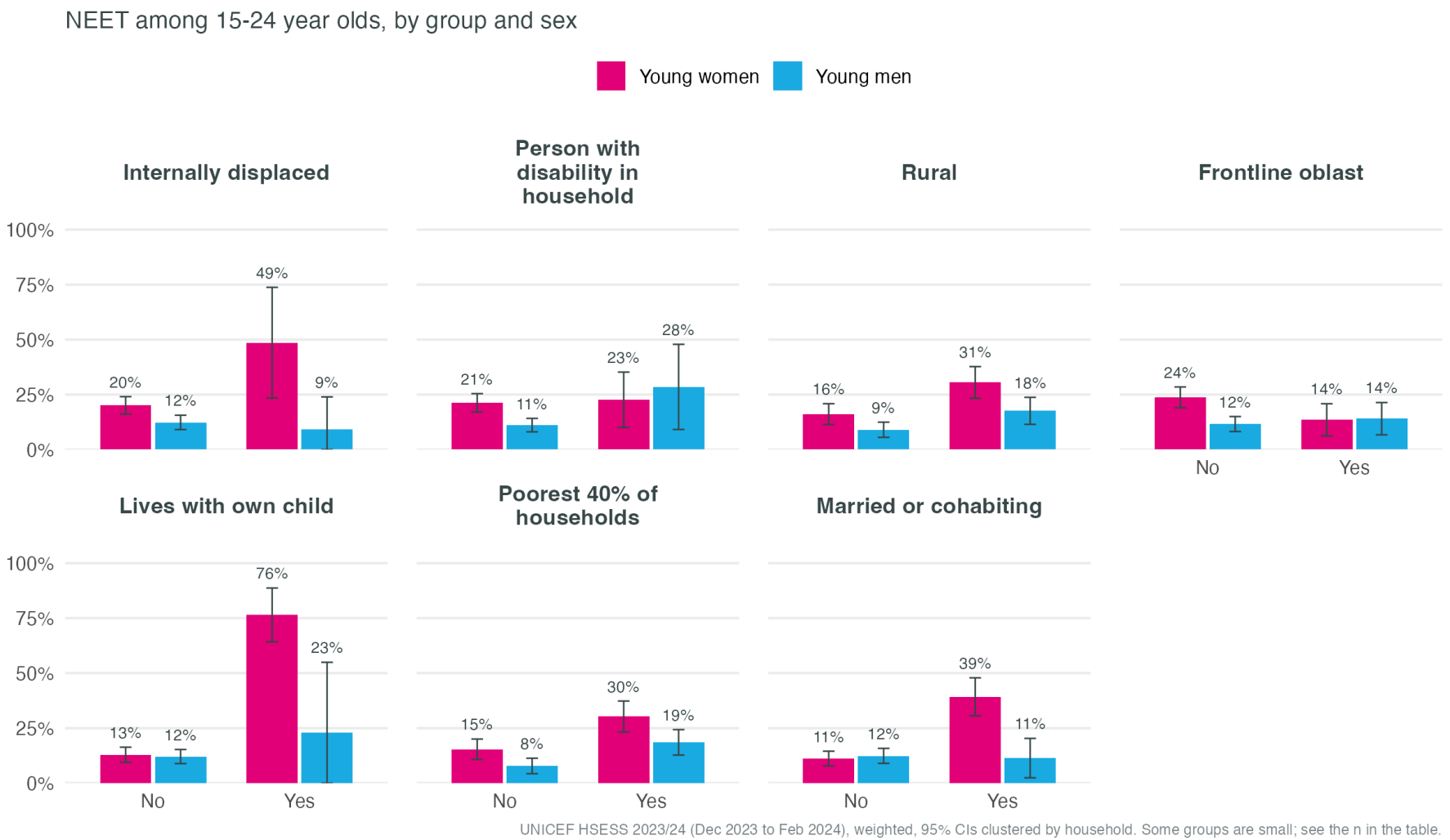
Ages 19–24 (n = 877). Employed: women 47%, men 48%. In education: women 31%, men 46%. NEET: women 30%, men 16%. Labour-force participation: employed, or looking for work or starting a business.

NEET rate at 15–24: 21% for women and 12% for men



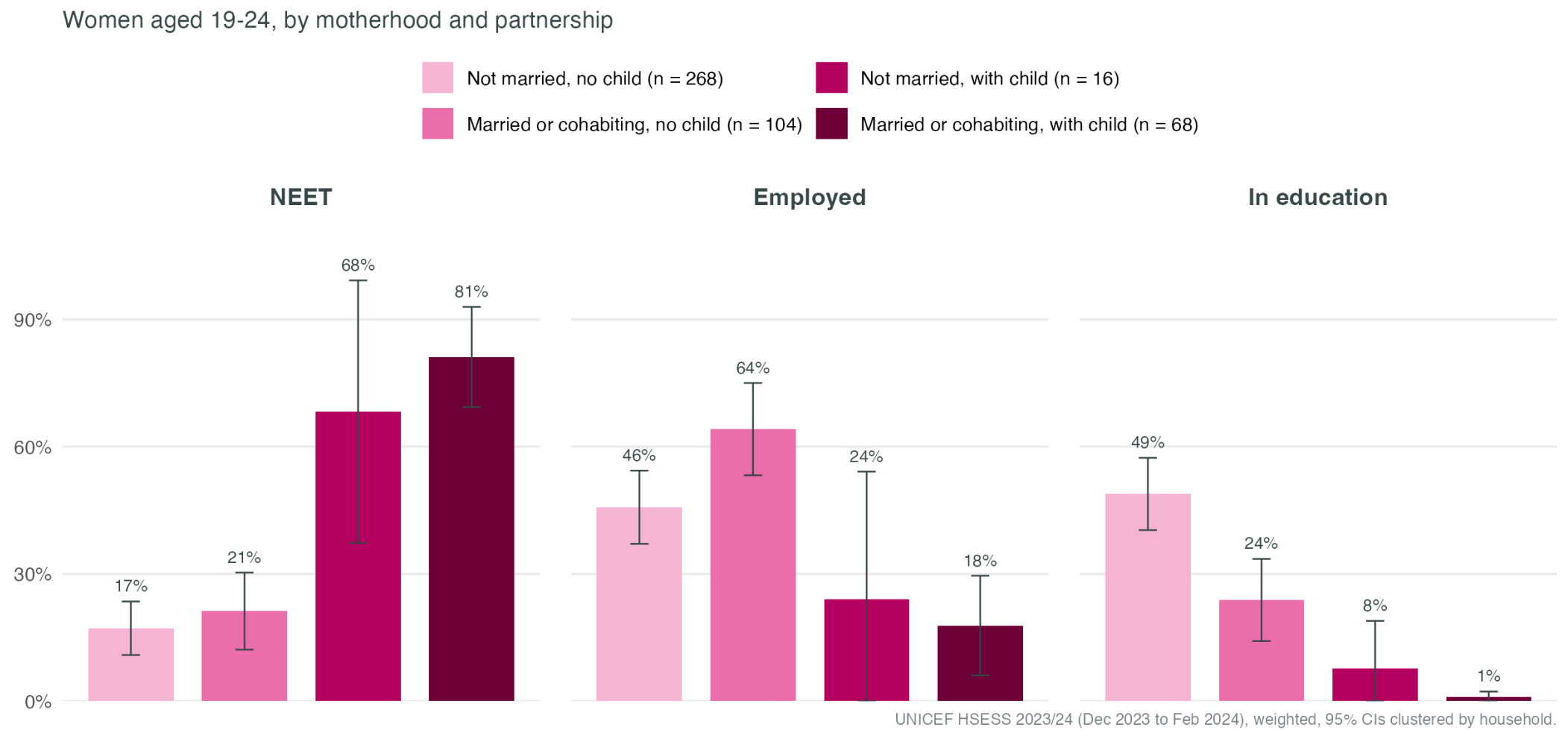
NEET at 15–29 (ILO age range): women 33%, men 12%.

NEET rate at 15–24 by displacement, disability, income, location and parenthood



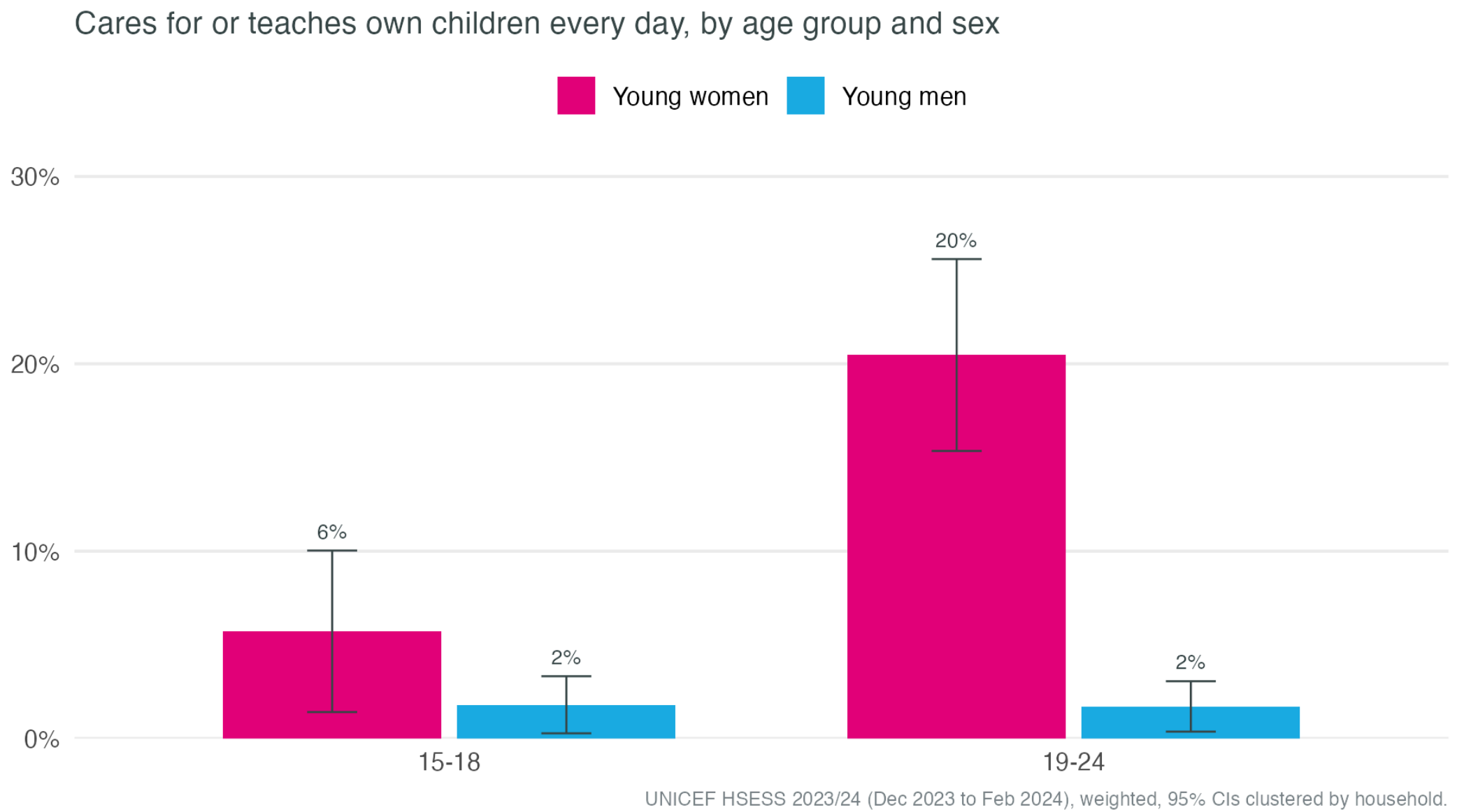
Disability refers to any household member (recorded at household level). Poorest 40%: household income per member. Lives with own child: own child under 18 in the household. Frontline oblasts: Donetsk, Kharkiv, Zaporizhzhia, Kherson, Mykolaiv, Sumy, Chernihiv, Dnipropetrovsk (to be confirmed). Displaced and disability groups have small samples; see the confidence intervals.

Women 19–24 by motherhood and partnership: 9% of mothers are not married or cohabiting

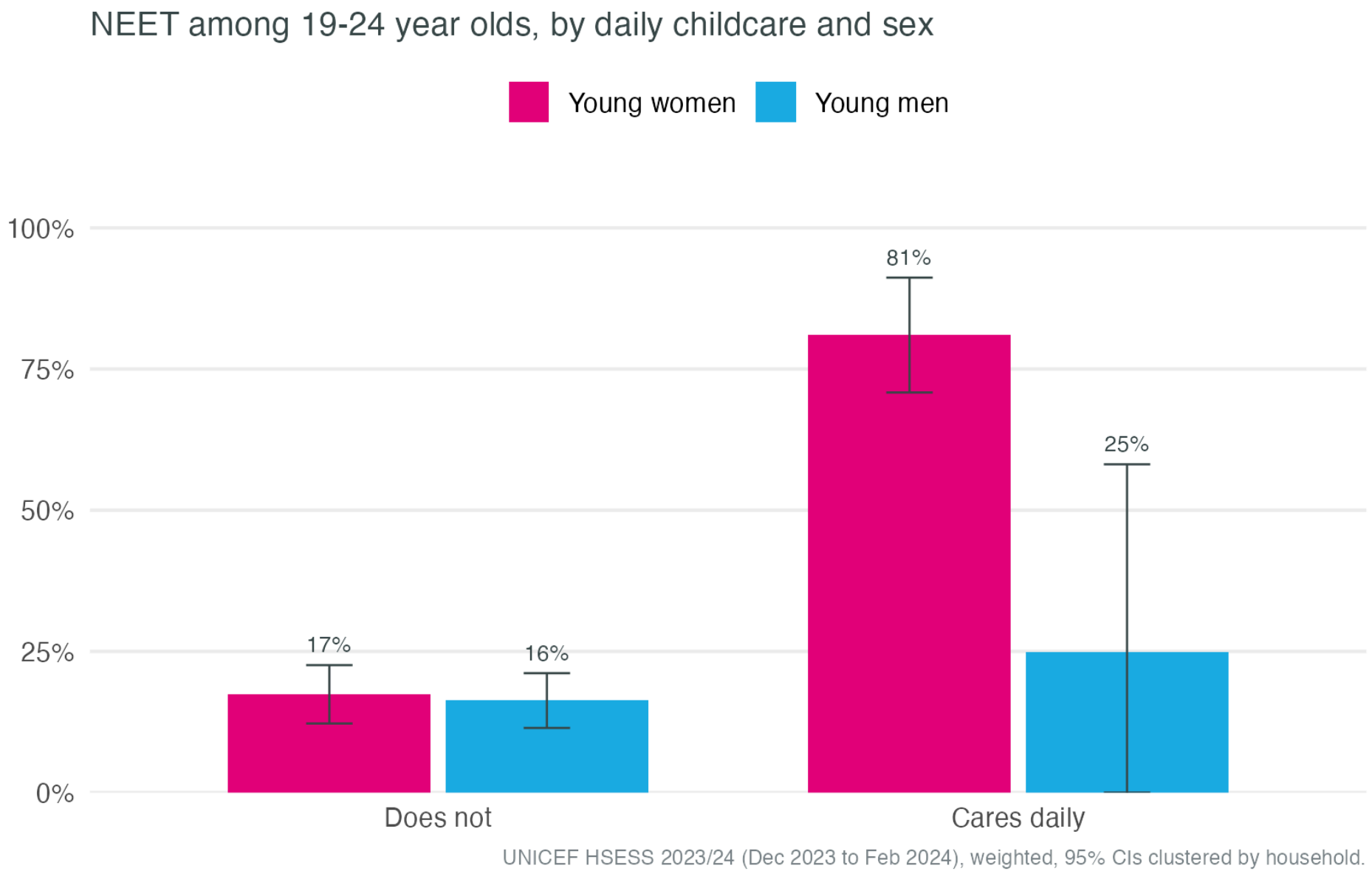


Mothers: women living with their own child under 18, identified from the household roster (relationships are recorded relative to the household respondent; n = 84 mothers aged 19–24). NEET among mothers: 80%; among women without children: 19%.

Daily care of own children: 20% of women and 2% of men aged 19–24

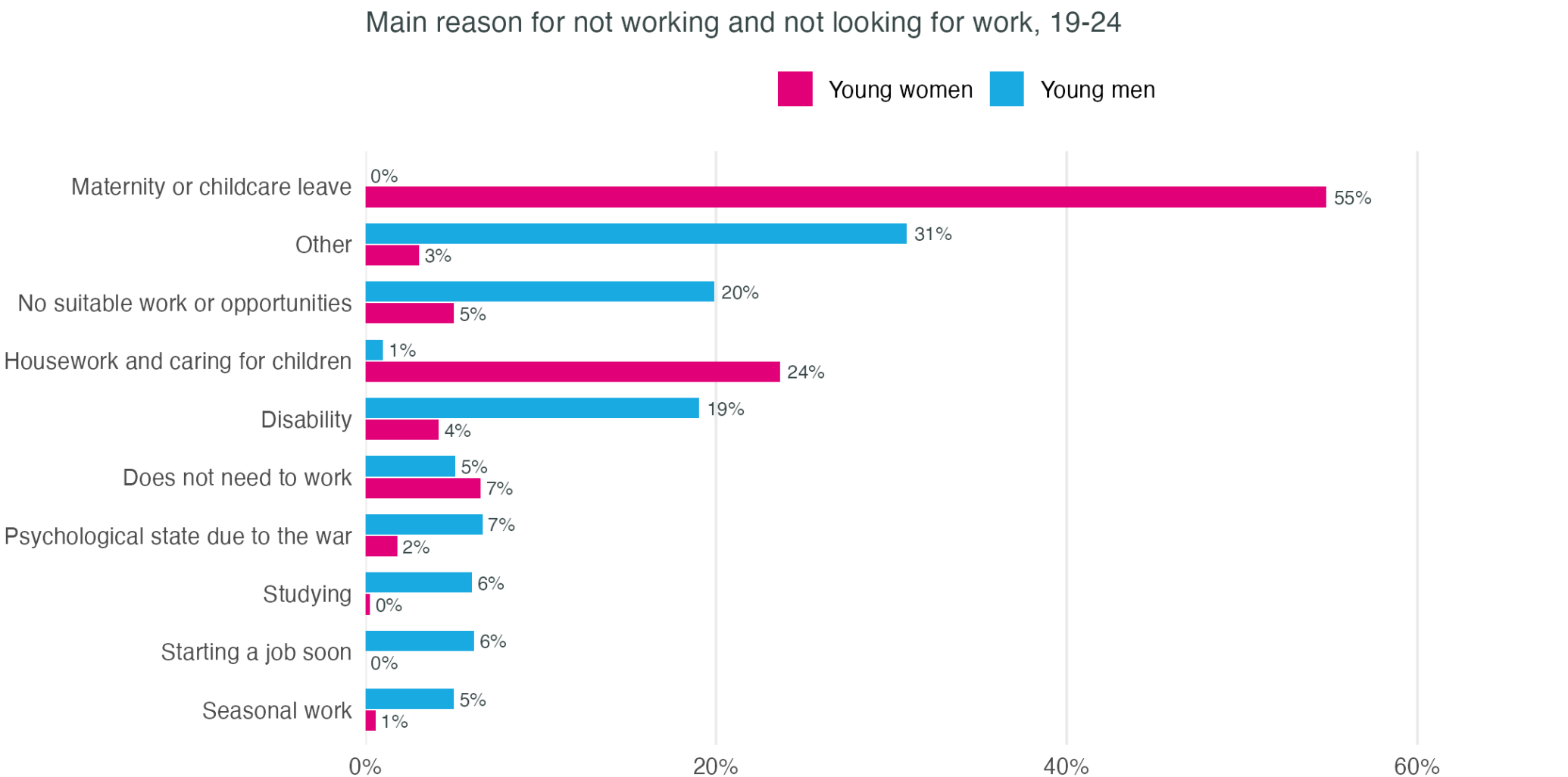


NEET rate by daily childcare, 19–24



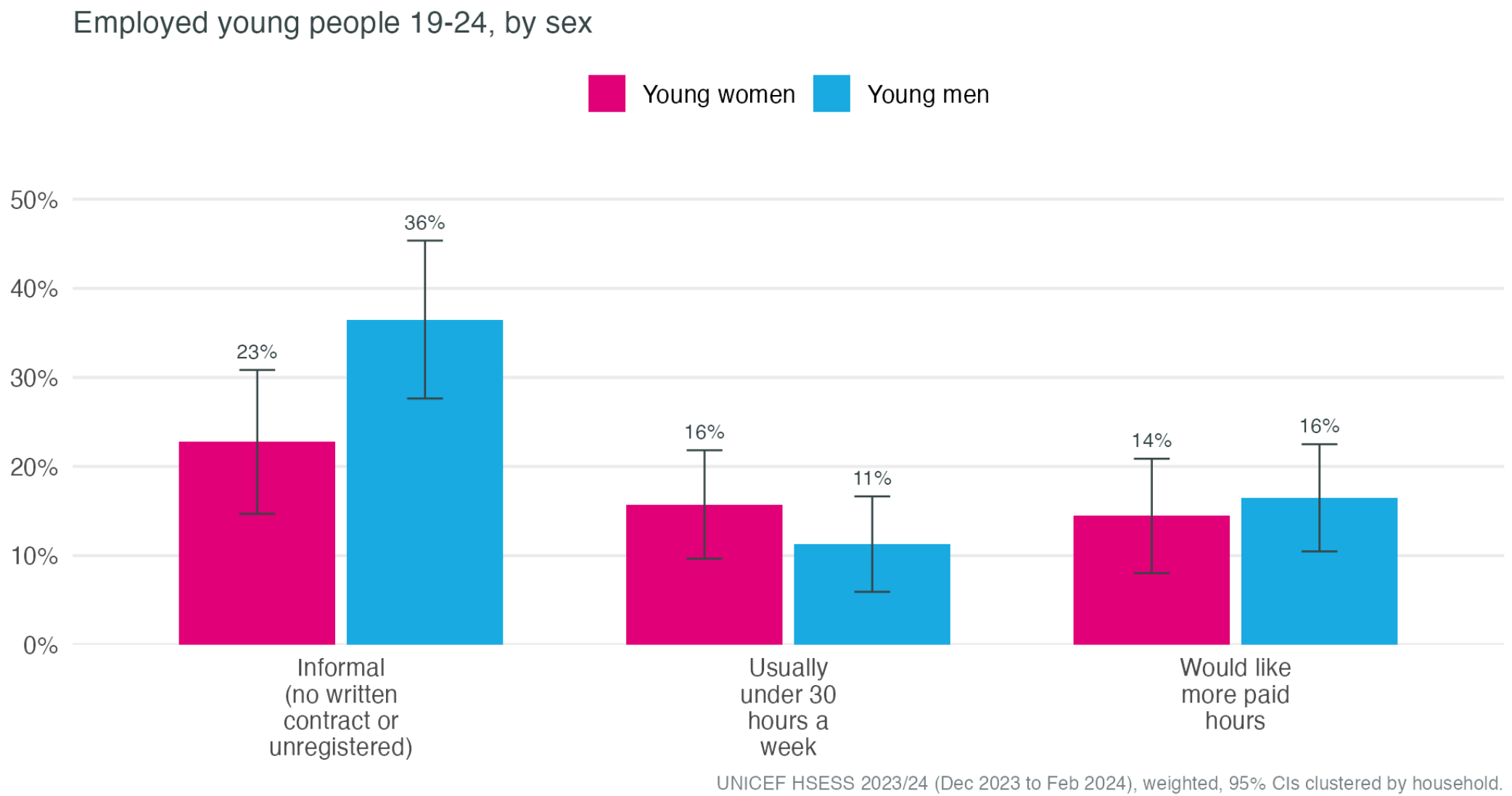
Daily care or teaching of own children and the NEET rate, by sex.

Main reason for not working and not looking for work, 19–24



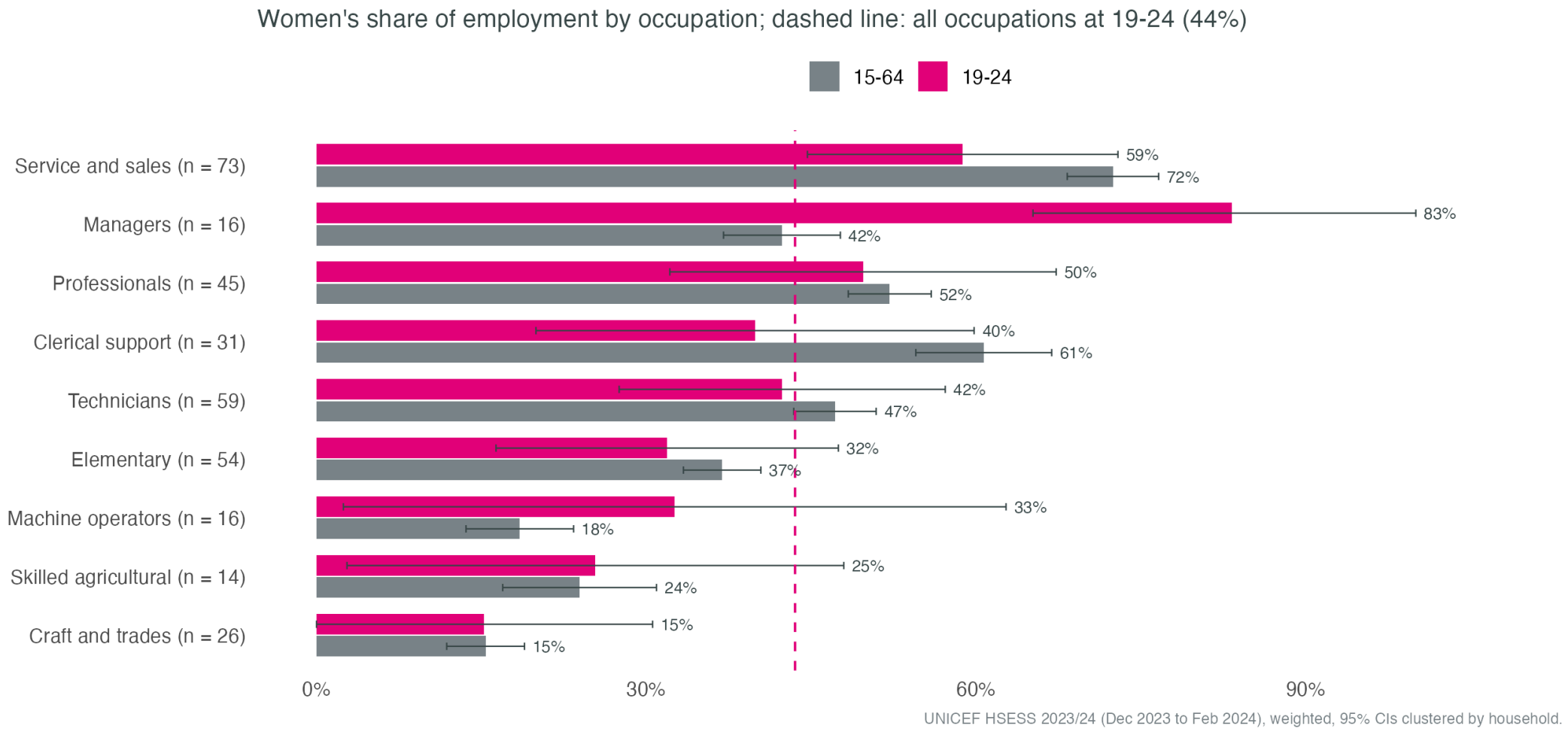
UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household. n = 112 women, 31 men.

Informal employment: 23% of employed women and 36% of employed men aged 19–24



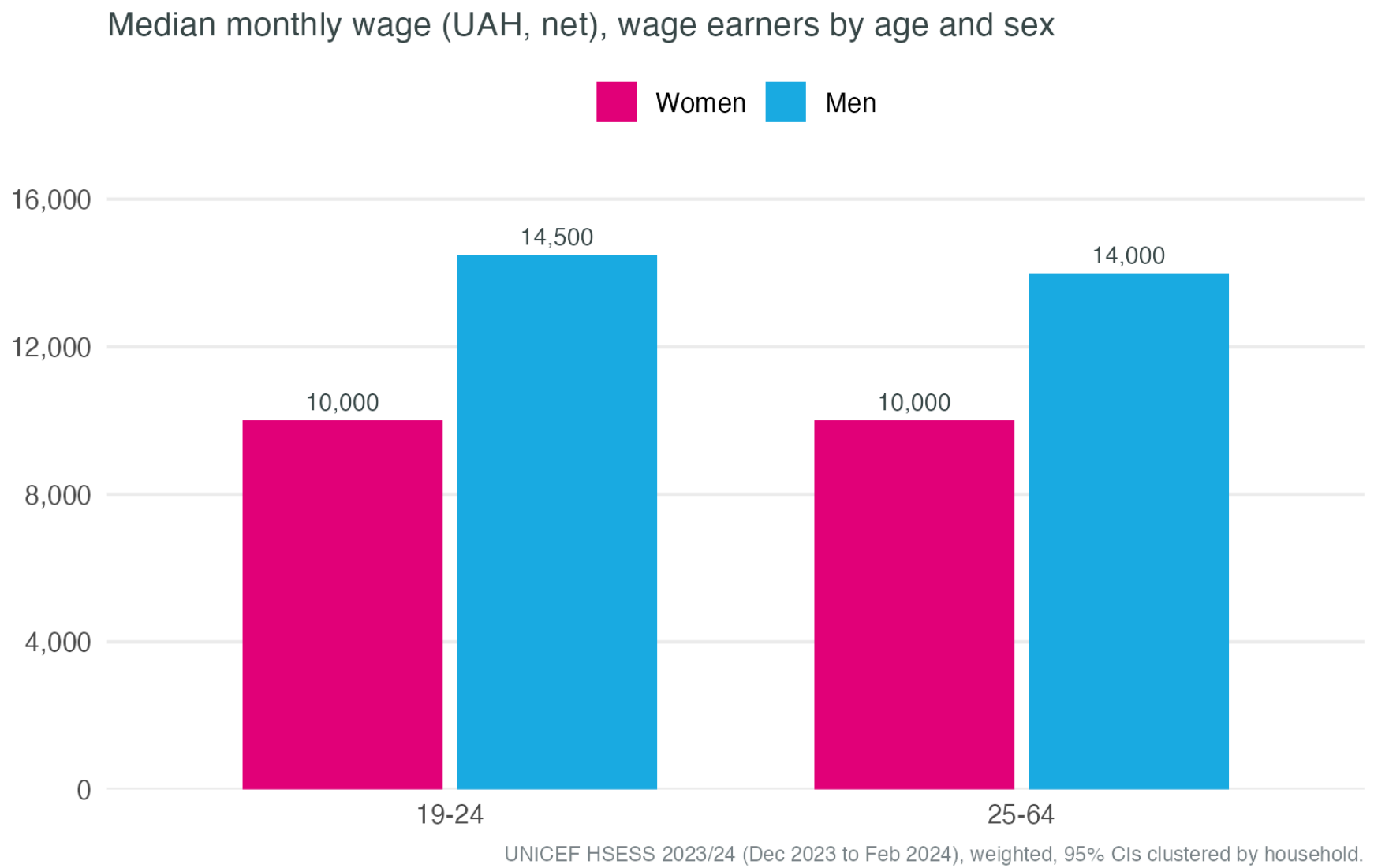
Informal: paid on a verbal agreement, own-account work without registration, or family farm work for sale.

Women’s share of employment by occupation



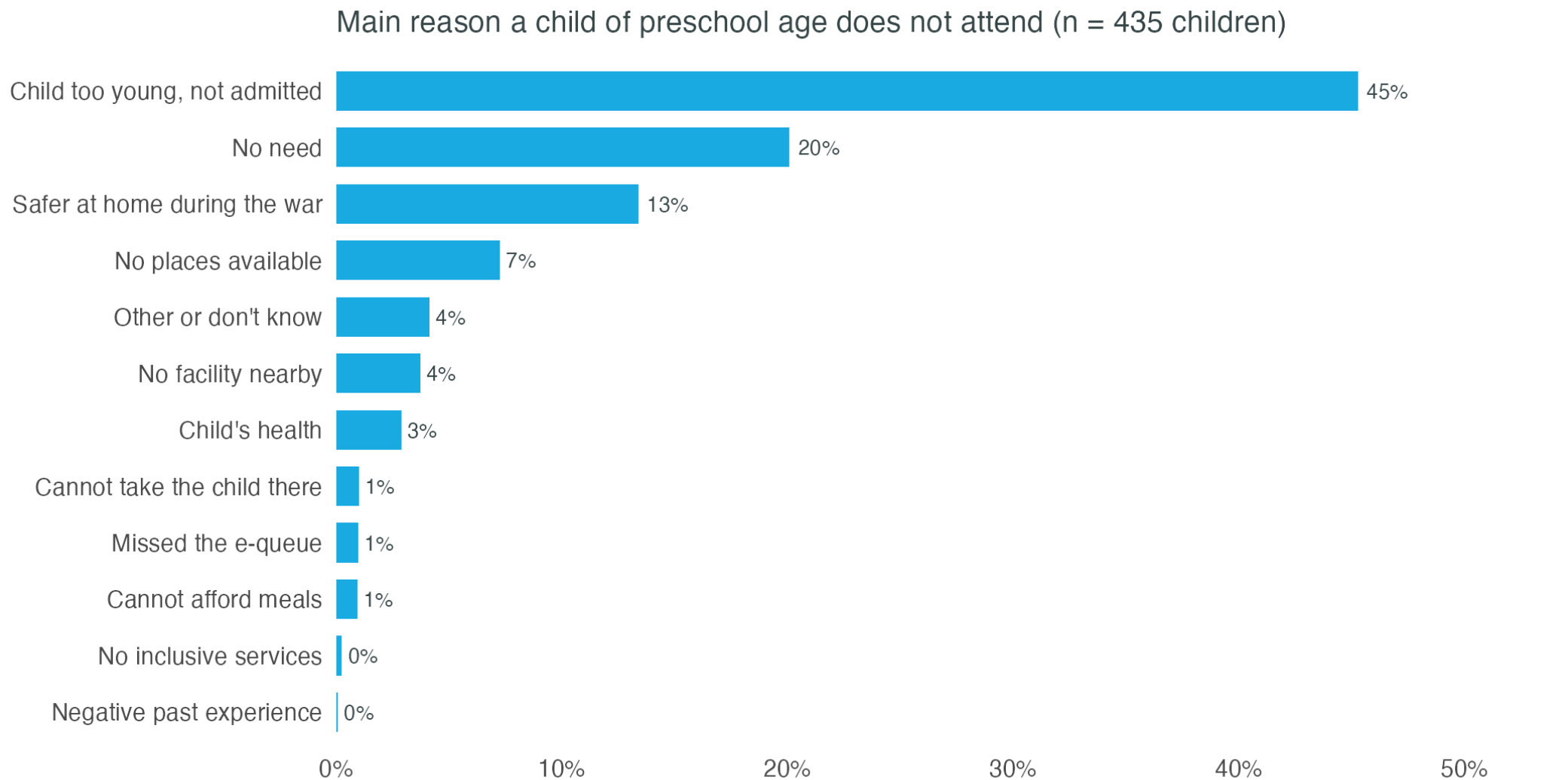
Occupation group as reported by the respondent (IND_B6_2), not coded from job titles. Groups for 19–24 have small samples (n shown); bars show 95% confidence intervals. The dashed line marks women’s share of all employment at 19–24.

Median monthly wage of women: 31% below men’s at 19–24 and 29% below at 25–64



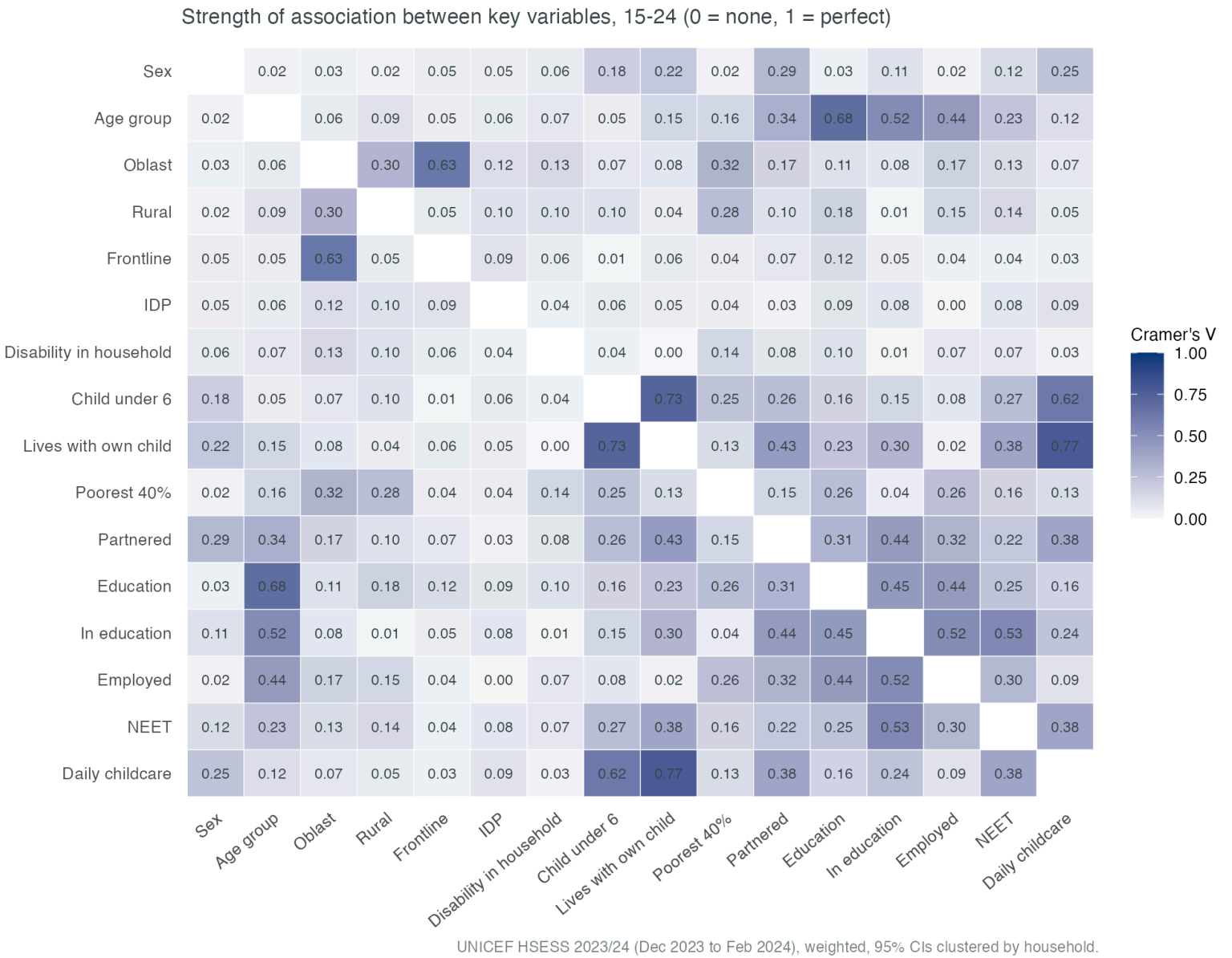
Net monthly wage reported by those whose main income is wages. Unadjusted difference in medians, which includes differences in hours, occupation and sector.

Main reason children of preschool age do not attend preschool



Children who would attend a preschool facility at their age but do not; main reason reported by the household.

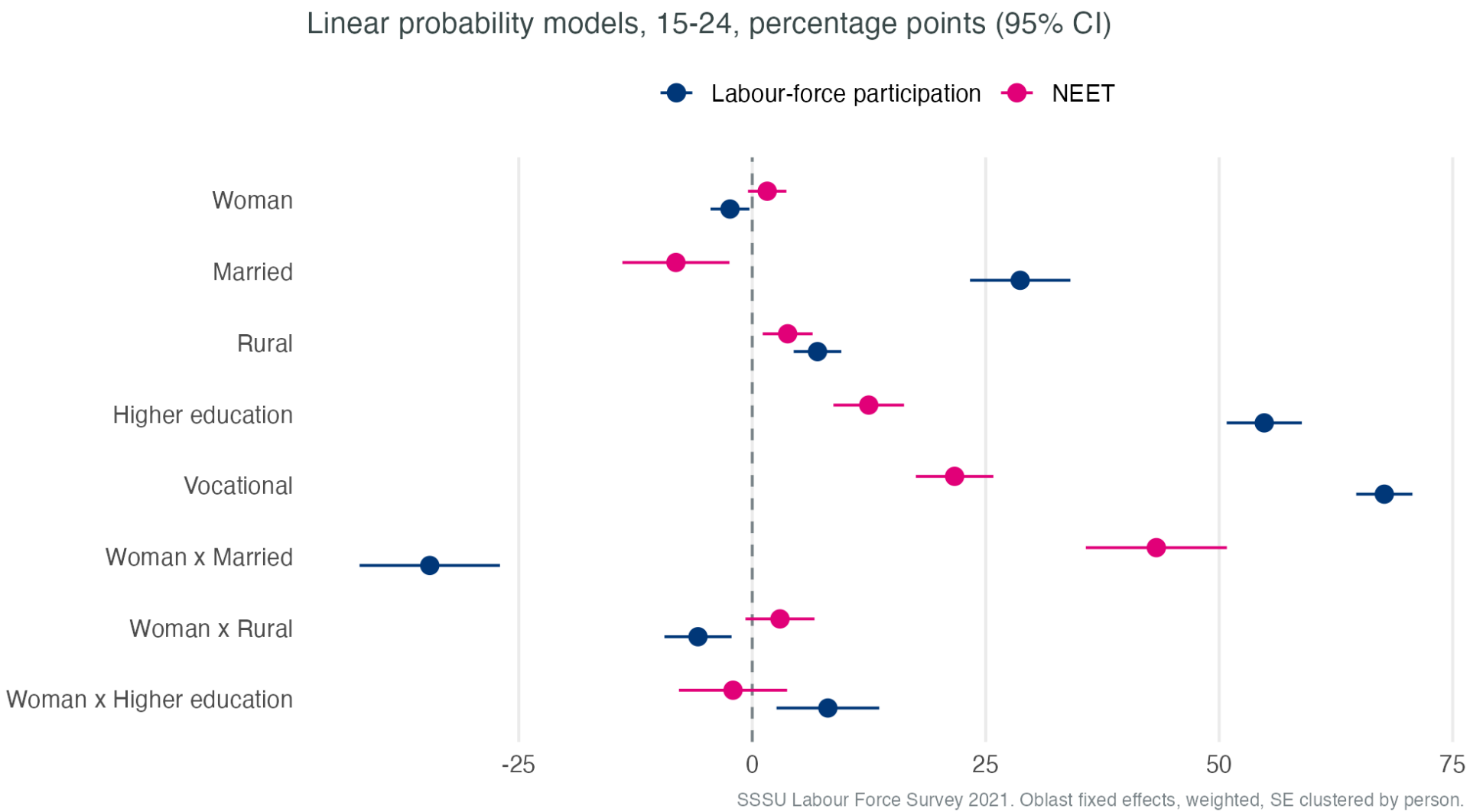
Association between key variables, 15–24



Cramer's V between each pair of variables, weighted (0 = no association, 1 = perfect association).

4 · Regression analysis

Linear probability models: NEET and labour-force participation, 15–24 (LFS 2021)



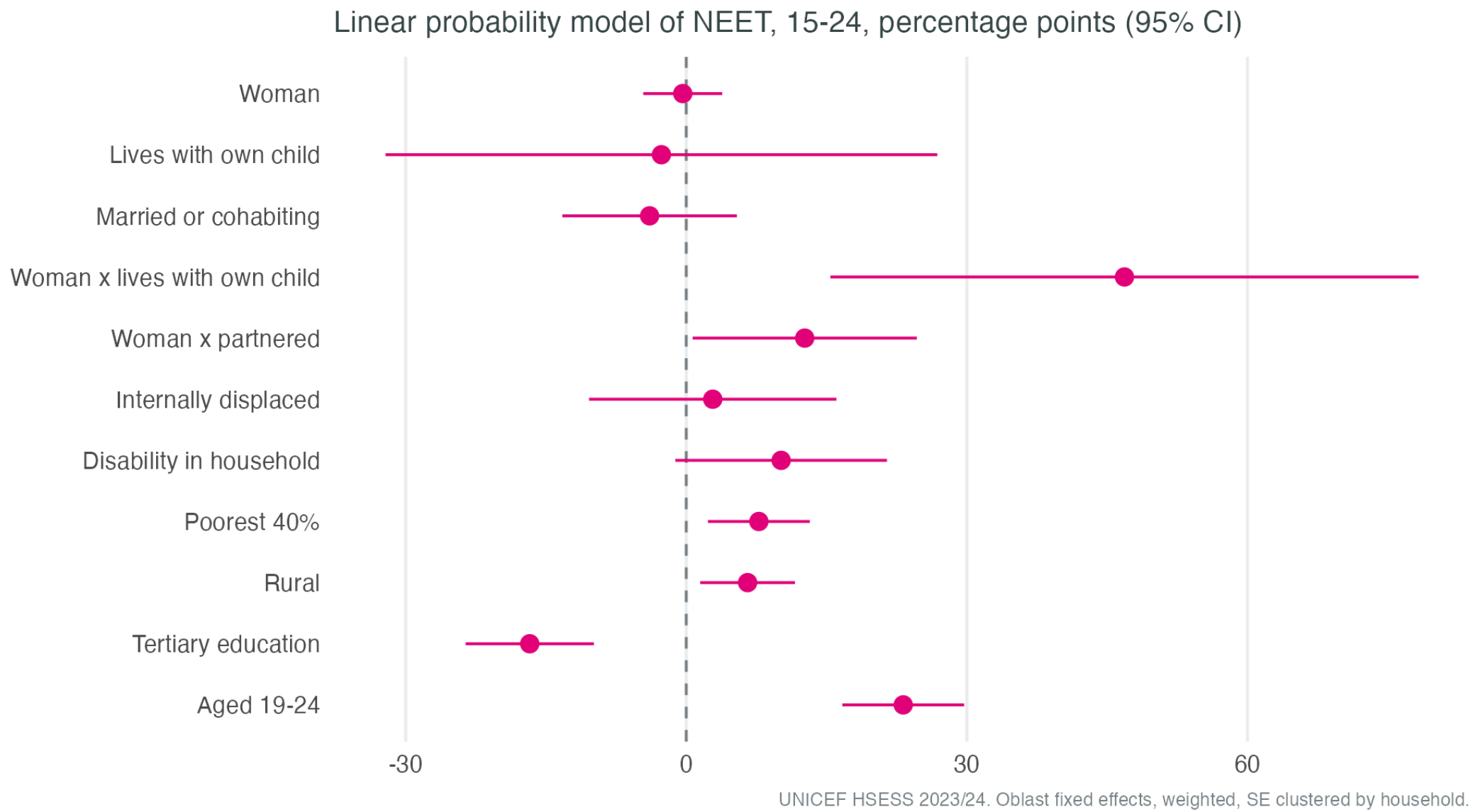
Oblast fixed effects, weighted, standard errors clustered by person. Interaction terms show how the difference between women and men varies with marital status, area and higher education. Associations, not causal effects.

Estimates, LFS 2021

Estimate	Sample	Effect (pp)	SE	p	N
NEET: women vs men	15-24	5.9	0.9	<0.001	19975
NEET: women vs men	15-29 (ILO frame)	11.7	0.8	<0.001	31012
Labour-force participation: women vs men	15-24	-5.6	0.9	<0.001	19975
Employment: women vs men	15-24	-5.8	0.9	<0.001	19975
NEET: woman x married	15-24	42.5	3.6	<0.001	19975
NEET: woman x rural	15-24	2.7	1.9	0.160	19975
NEET: woman x higher education	15-24	4.2	2.8	0.140	19975
Informal employment: women vs men	15-24 employed	-4.3	1.9	0.025	4904
Home duties as reason for inactivity: women vs men	15-24 inactive	3.9	0.6	<0.001	14687

Effects in percentage points. Controls: urban/rural, education and marital status (except where interacted), oblast fixed effects. The 15–29 estimate also controls for age band.

Linear probability model: NEET, 15–24 (HSESS 2023/24)



Oblast fixed effects, weighted, standard errors clustered by household. Associations, not causal effects.

Estimates, HSESS 2023/24

Estimate	Sample	Effect (pp)	SE	p	N
NEET: women vs men	15-24	3.9	2.1	0.067	1687
NEET: woman x lives with own child	15-24	55.5	15.6	<0.001	1687
NEET: woman x married or cohabiting	15-24	19.7	6.4	0.002	1687
NEET: internally displaced	15-24	4.0	6.9	0.560	1687
NEET: person with disability in household	15-24	10.0	6.0	0.095	1687
NEET: poorest 40% of households	15-24	6.5	2.8	0.019	1687
NEET: woman x poorest 40%	15-24	3.5	4.7	0.470	1687
NEET: rural	15-24	7.8	2.6	0.003	1687

Effects in percentage points. Controls: age 19–24, rural, displacement, disability in household, poorest 40%, lives with own child, partnership and tertiary education (except where interacted), oblast fixed effects.

5 · Next steps

Points for discussion

1. Age groups: 15–18 and 19–24, with 15–24 and 15–29 for NEET.

2. Sectors to cover in the analysis of occupations: reconstruction, technical and digital, energy, manufacturing, green and care.

3. Frontline oblasts used for the regional breakdown.

4. Data: MICS-7 2025/26 microdata, SSSU wage statistics by occupation and sex, and public expenditure on skills, employment services and childcare.

Next analyses

Regressions: contribution of childcare, displacement, disability, income and location to NEET, separately for 15–18 and 19–24; the same models on MICS-7 once available.

Cost of inaction: forgone earnings, output and fiscal revenue associated with differences in participation and NEET, using the benefit-cost framework of **A Brighter Future** (2024).

Occupations: check the self-reported occupation groups against the reported job titles, in particular the shares of women among machine operators and managers.

Private sector: costs and returns for employers of internships and apprenticeships combined with childcare support.

Appendix

HSESS variables used

Variable	Code	Variable	Code	Variable	Code
key (ind)	questionnaire key	econ_status (ind)	IND_B1	income_amount (ind)	IND_V1_1_1
weight (ind)	final weight	job_type (ind)	IND_B3_1	n_children (ind)	dity_n
oblast (ind)	OBLAST	sector (ind)	IND_B5_2	hh_size (ind)	hh_size
settlement (ind)	SETTL_TYPE	job_title (ind)	IND_B6_1	key (hh)	questionnaire key
relation (ind)	IND_A1	occupation (ind)	IND_B6_2	hh_income (hh)	V1
age (ind)	IND_A2	hours (ind)	IND_B9_1	disab_adult (hh)	D1_Mult3
sex (ind)	IND_A3	attitude (ind)	IND_B10_1	disab_child (hh)	D1_Mult4
marital (ind)	IND_A6	why_not_working (ind)	IND_B17_1	idp_hh (hh)	D1_Mult9
educ_level (ind)	IND_A7	seeking (ind)	IND_B21	veteran (hh)	D1_Mult10
in_educ (ind)	IND_A9	reason_inactive (ind)	IND_B24	lost_home (hh)	G3_5_1
institution (ind)	IND_A10	care_children (ind)	IND_B28_1	damaged_home (hh)	G3_5_2
preschool_reason (ind)	IND_A14	care_disabled (ind)	IND_B28_3	wealth (hh)	V16
moved (ind)	IND_A15	care_elderly (ind)	IND_B28_4		
idp (ind)	IND_A19	income_source (ind)	IND_V1_1		

Codes as in the questionnaire and the “variables_ukr” sheet of each HSESS file; “ind” = individual file, “hh” = household file.